

ID: SOMA-M-P11

Title: Listening Practice

Duration: 10m 00s (706 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore sounds in your environment. Listening is often automatic, but in this practice, the invitation is to become more attentive to the sounds around you. You may notice reactions to sounds – pleasant, unpleasant, or somewhere in the middle. All are part of the moment. You can notice them without labeling, preferring, or rejecting.

[Short Pause] (10s - Attuning)

Before beginning, ensure your space supports attentive listening. Sit or stand comfortably, in a position where you can remain safe and stable. There is no need to cut all sounds, the practice is about engaging with them fully, wherever they arise.

[Short Pause] (10s - Environmental check)

As you proceed, gentleness with your attention is helpful. The mind may have a habit pattern to judge or categorize sounds, or to ignore them entirely. When this happens, gently bring attention back to listening, allowing all sounds to come and go naturally.

Begin by settling into a comfortable position. Allow the body to feel fully supported by the floor, chair, or cushion beneath you. Rest your arms naturally at your sides or on your lap. Take a slow, gentle breath in... and release it completely, letting the body and mind arrive in the present moment.

Allow yourself to settle fully into this practice. Notice the support beneath you, the alignment of your spine, and the soft resting of your shoulders. Allow awareness of sound to anchor you in the present moment.

[Short Pause] (10s - Grounding)

Bring your attention to the act of listening. Notice the sounds present around you: some near, some far, some soft, some loud. You do not need to label them or analyze them. Allow them to exist.

Notice each sound without judgment. Do not try to hold onto any sound, and do not try to push any sound away. Let every sound arrive naturally and leave naturally. Allow yourself to be present with them exactly as they are right now in this moment.

[Long Pause] (20s - General listening)

Shift your awareness to the qualities of the sounds themselves. Some may be sharp, some soft; some high, some low; some brief, others may last longer. Observe these qualities without labeling them as good or bad. Notice how attention may move from one sound to another. When the mind drifts, gently return attention to the simple act of noticing. Letting each sound be fully present in your awareness.

[Long Pause] (30s - Sound qualities)

Allow your awareness to include the sounds closest to you first. Perhaps you notice subtle movements of your own body, the rustle of clothing, or the rhythm of your breathing. Observe these sounds with gentle curiosity as part of this present experience.

Gradually expand attention outward, letting more distant or subtle sounds enter your awareness. Observe them as they arise, without needing to control, interpret, or react. Allow each sound to be received fully, in its own time and place.

[Long Pause] (20s - Near and far sounds)

If the mind wanders, as it naturally will, notice this gently. Thoughts, memories, or plans may arise. Do your best to acknowledge them without judgment, and return attention to the sounds around you.

Notice what shows up without resistance, without needing to change anything. Each sound, each pause, each moment is complete in itself. You can return to the present moment whenever you choose, without pressure or expectation.

Pause now, allowing sounds to arrive and depart naturally. Notice how some fade quickly, others linger longer. Some are constant, others irregular. Observe the rhythm of your environment, letting your awareness meet it with gentleness.

[Long Pause] (20s - Rhythms of environment)

With each observation, your attention becomes steadier. Notice that patience and presence are developed in every moment of listening.

[Short Pause] (10s - Deepening focus)

Bring attention now to the subtle effects of sound on your body. Notice how certain tones may evoke a slight shift in posture, a tightening or relaxation of muscles, or a subtle change in breathing.

Let these bodily responses happen without judgment, arising and passing naturally. Notice that the body's responses are also part of the present moment, and each is worthy of gentle attention.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Finally, bring your awareness back to the body as a whole. Feel the support beneath you, the alignment of your spine, and the gentle resting of your arms. Notice that sounds continue, but you are present, grounded, and accepting. Take a slow breath in... and release it fully.

Thank you for your practice.

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